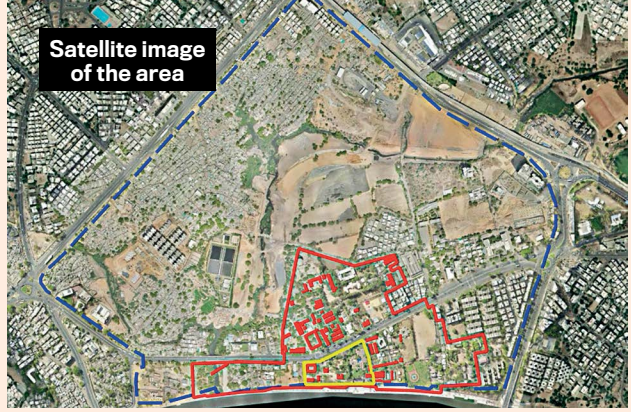
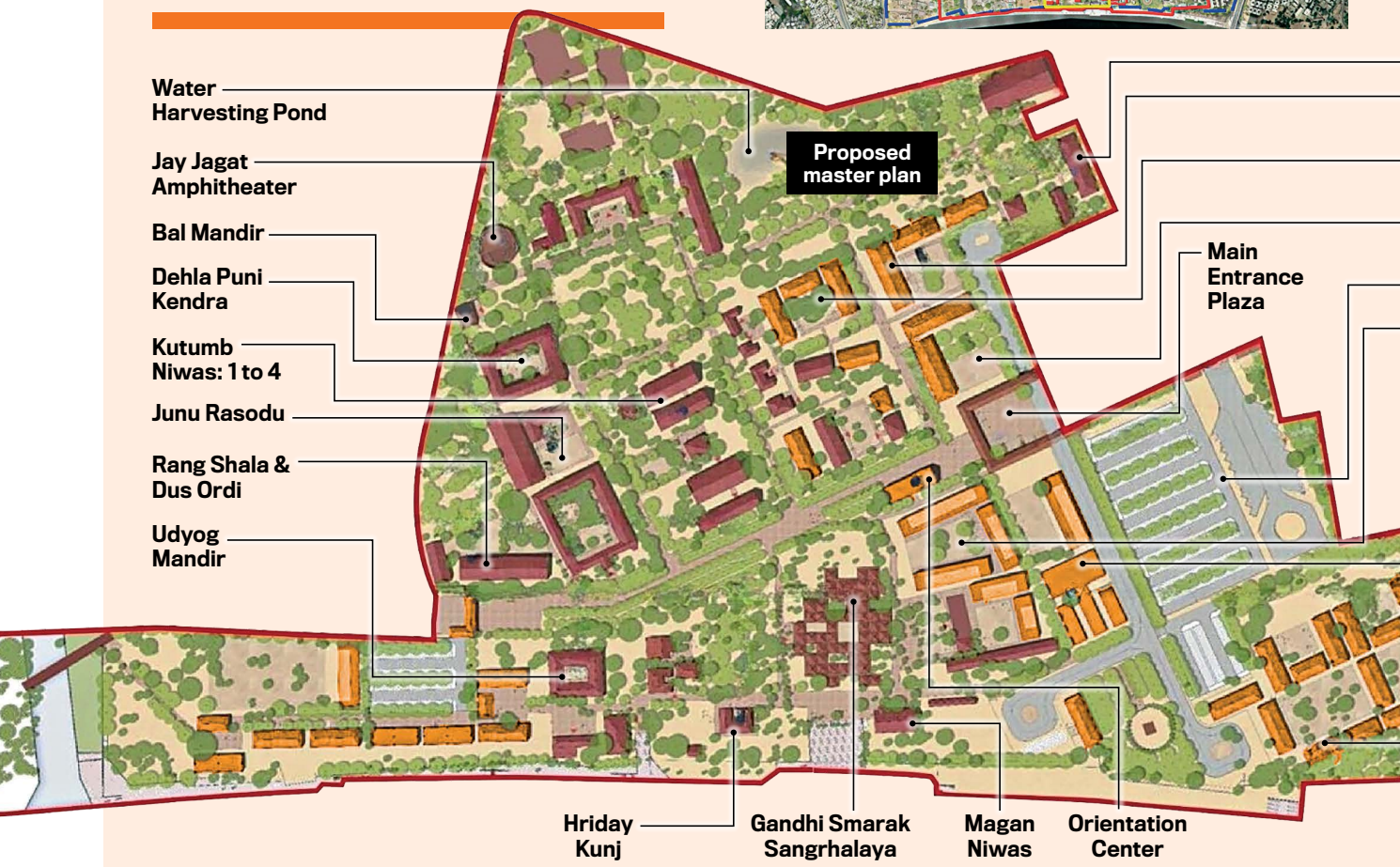
MORE THAN A FACELIFT

THE PROJECT AIMS TO CONSERVE, RESTORE AND REPRODUCE PARTS OF THE ORIGINAL ASHRAM, WHILE ADDING VISITOR AMENITIES





The announcement of the Sabarmati Ashram development project in 2021—to be executed at an estimated cost of Rs 1,200 crore—had raised concerns from a section of Gandhians and the general public that the ashram's serene precincts would be turned into a "Gandhi theme park", but the information that has been trickling in about the intended revamp since seems to have allayed some of the fears, at least about the built structure, said those INDIA TODAY spoke with. With detailed plans yet to be released, however, apprehensions remain about the narrative on Mahatma Gandhi's life to be presented at the new ashram complex. According to members of the Gandhian community, these concerns will be put to rest only once the details of exhibits at the revamped ashram are made public. Meanwhile, another question that continues to

PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

- **According to the masterplan, access at ashram will increase from the current five acres to 55 acres**
- **20 buildings to be conserved, 13 to be restored**
- **Structures that form the core of the ashram, including the Mahatma's residential quarters, to remain untouched**
- **322 acres around ashram to be developed for better visitor experience**
- **Revamped ashram to include exhibitions on Gandhi, cafeteria, souvenir shops, meeting rooms, amphitheatre and interactive workshops, and more**